

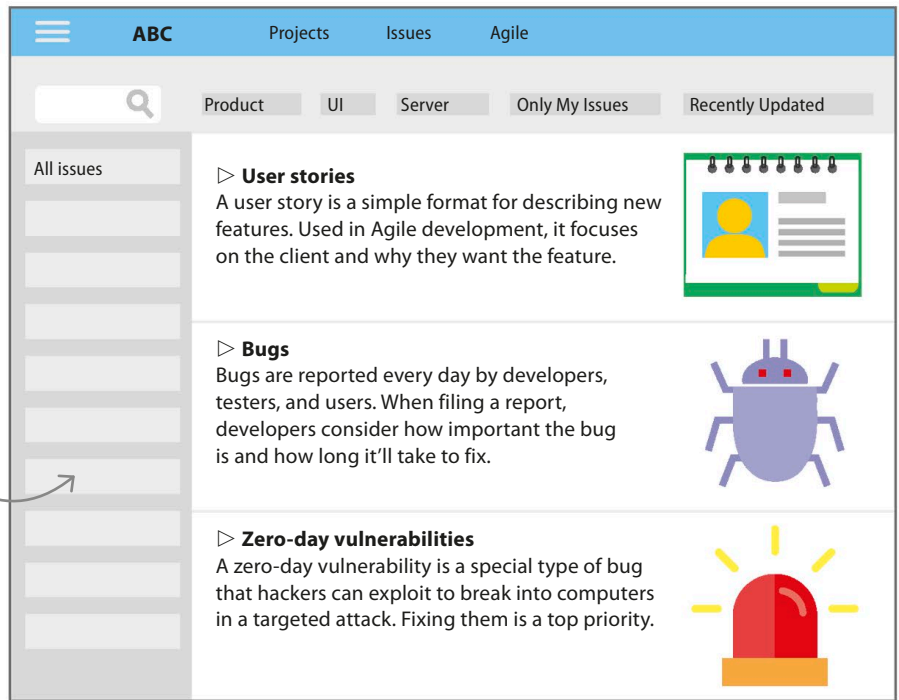
Maintenance

In the early stages of a project, developers write lots of code and design new systems. Once the details have been hammered out and the software has matured, development becomes a matter of small tweaks. The types of improvement done on older programs can be separated into three main categories.

Issue-tracking software helps developers organize their tweaks.

▷ More issue types

Issue-tracking software has many options for classifying issues including tasks, sub-tasks, stories, bugs, incidents, service requests, changes, and problems.



Updates

A typical update includes a couple of new features and as many bug fixes as the development team could achieve. The new code is packaged into a "bundle" which clients can download. The bundle only contains code files whose instructions have changed.



◁ Apps

Some apps update automatically, while others request the user's permission through a pop-up window. The device's update manager is responsible for switching out old files with new ones, and restarting the program.

Updated files are sent to the user's browser when they refresh.



▷ Websites

Often, a website can be updated without disturbing users. It's as simple as saving changes to an HTML file or replacing a script.

Upgrades

While it's important to keep software well maintained, companies want to limit the time invested in outdated programs. Even the most dependable computer can't run forever. Sooner or later it's time to upgrade to a better model with new and improved features. An upgrade, unlike an update, is completely new software with brand new code. It's designed to fully replace the older program.

